



upcurved wingtips

powerful feet for killing

▽ SEEING OFF A FOX

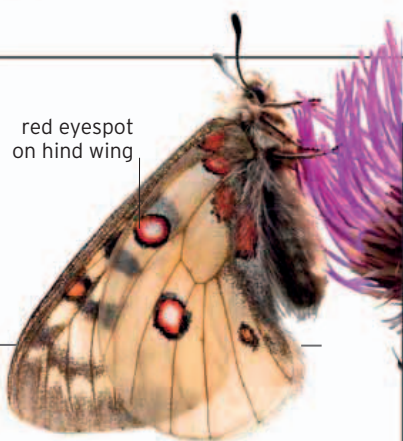
This immature golden eagle is still big and strong enough to chase away a red fox that has tried to steal its meal.



Apollo butterfly

Parnassius apollo

Although widespread across Europe's mountainous regions, this unusual member of the swallowtail family is an endangered species. Its color pattern of pale wings dotted with black and red spots is so variable that dozens of subspecies have been identified, some of which are restricted to a single alpine valley. Females lay their eggs close to plants such as stonecrop; the caterpillars eat the leaves when they hatch.



red eyespot on hind wing

△ NECTAR OF THE GODS

Adult Apollos can be seen drinking nectar from flowers in mountain meadows at the height of summer.

- ↔ 2–4 in (5–10 cm)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🌿 Leaves; nectar
- 🏠 Europe, W. Asia

Large mountain grasshopper

Stauroderus scalaris

This is the largest species of grasshopper in Europe, and in late summer, alpine meadows resound with its whirring stridulations, or “songs.” The bright green males sing to attract the larger, drab brown females.

▷ PREPARED TO JUMP

Grasshoppers have long wings, but instead of flying away from danger, they usually jump, using their large, powerful hind legs.

- ↔ ¾–1 in (1.8–2.7 cm)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌿 Grass, spurge, leaves
- 🏠 Europe, E. to C. Asia

